



DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL NEWTOWN
SESSION 2021-22
MONDAY TEST

CLASS: VIII
SUBJECT: ENGLISH PAPER I (SET A)

FULL MARKS: 40
DATE: 1.11.21

General Instructions:

- The question paper consists of three printed pages.
- Answers should be to the point.
- Copy the question numbers carefully before answering the questions.
- Marks will be deducted for spelling errors.

Question 1

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow:

There was one pet which Grandfather could not keep for very long. Grandmother was tolerant of some birds and animals but she drew the line at reptiles. Grandfather should have known that there was little chance of being allowed to keep a python.

He could never resist buying unusual pets and while we still had Toto, the monkey, he paid a snake-charmer in the market only four rupees for the young four-foot python that was on display to a crowd of eager boys and girls. Grandfather impressed the gathering by slinging the python over his shoulders and walking home with it.

The first to see them arrive was Toto, swinging from a branch of the jackfruit tree. One look at the python, ancient enemy of his race and he fled into the house squealing with fright. Toto hid under the sofa. Grandmother nearly fainted at the sight of the python curled round Grandfather's throat. She was dumbstruck for a while. After few seconds, she shouted at Grandfather and ordered him to get rid of it at once.

"Nonsense!" said Grandfather. "He's only a young fellow – he'll soon get used to us." "He might, indeed," said Grandmother, "I have no intention of getting used to him."

Grandfather said, "Well, I can't leave it loose in the garden. It might find its way into the poultry house and then where would we be?"

"Oh, how irritating you are!" grumbled Grandmother. "Lock the thing in the bathroom, then go out and find the man you bought it from and get him to come here and collect it."

Finally, Grandfather took the python into the bathroom and placed it in the tub.

"Perhaps Grandmother is right this time," he said. "We don't want the snake to get hold of Toto. It's sure to be hungry."

He hurried off to the market to look for the snake-charmer. He was gone for about two hours while Grandmother paced up and down the balcony. While Grandfather returned, looking crestfallen, we knew he was unable to find the snake-charmer.

"Well, then kindly take it away yourself," said Grandmother. "Leave it in the jungle across the river-bed". "All right but let me feed it first," said Grandfather.

a) Give the meaning of the following words as used in the passage: One-word answers or short phrases will be accepted. [3]

- i) slinging
- ii) dumbstruck
- iii) grumbled

b) Answer the following questions briefly.

- i) Whom did Grandfather buy the python from? How much did it cost? [2]
- ii) How did Grandfather impress the gathering in the market? [2]
- iii) What did Grandfather think might happen if the python would be left loose in the garden? [1]
- iv) What did Grandmother request Grandfather to do when he was unable to find the snake-charmer to return the python? [2]
- v) 'Grandfather was an animal lover'. Justify the statement with close reference to the given text. [2]

c) In not more than 50 words describe the reaction of Toto and Grandmother when they saw the python with Grandfather for the first time. [8]

Question 2

a) Fill in the blanks with the correct Preposition: [5]

- i) We should not deviate _____ our objective.
- ii) I came _____ some foreigners in the village.
- iii) _____ Literature, what did you study at University?
- iv) The king was blind _____ one eye.
- v) This secret should strictly remain _____ two of us.

b) Correct the incorrect Prepositions and rewrite the sentences: [5]

- i) If we set in early, we can return before sunset.
- ii) The Principal does not approve at indiscipline.
- iii) We failed to agree for a common plan of action.
- iv) Rashi has applied with a scholarship.
- v) This novel has been written to Jeffrey Archer.

Question 3

a) Change the Degree of Comparison of Adjectives, without changing the meaning of the sentence: [5]

- i) Diamond is the costliest of all gems. (Change to Comparative Degree)**
- ii) Dr. Ashok is one of the most dedicated doctors in this hospital. (Change to Positive Degree)**
- iii) Mt. Everest is higher than all other mountain peaks in the world. (Change to Superlative Degree)**
- iv) The Rajdhani express runs faster than any other train. (Change to Positive Degree)**
- v) Reema is not as good a dancer as Shaina. (Change to Comparative Degree)**

b) Do as directed: [5]

- i) Very few Indian leaders were as great as Mahatma Gandhi. (Use: greater)**
- ii) Australia is the smallest continent. (Begin: No other.....)**
- iii) Akbar was the wisest Mughal emperor. (End with: Akbar)**
- iv) Mrinal is not as clever as Samir. (Begin: Samir.....)**
- v) No other girl in the group is as brave as Akshita. (Use: bravest)**